SERVERPILOT

Website MVP Specification

Product showcase website built with Astro

Your servers. One desktop. Full control.

A clean, minimal website that introduces ServerPilot, demonstrates the desktop application, explains its features, and guides visitors to download it.

Visual direction Minimalist monochrome · White, black, and neutral gray · Smooth, restrained animation

Technology Astro · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · React islands only where useful

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1. Product overview

ServerPilot is a locally installed, cross-platform desktop application for managing VPS servers directly over SSH. This website is the public product showcase and download destination. It is not the server management application itself.

Website goals

- Explain what ServerPilot does in a few seconds.
- Show the real desktop application interface using clear screenshots.
- Present the features that are available in the current release.
- Explain the local-first model: the desktop app runs on the user's machine and connects directly to VPS servers.
- Make downloading and installing the application straightforward.
- Provide documentation, release notes, and project links.

Product positioning

Primary message: Your servers. One desktop. Full control.

Supporting message: Manage your VPS servers from one desktop application. Connect through SSH, monitor resources, manage services, browse files, and work with your servers without constantly switching between terminals and dashboards.

The website should clearly state that ServerPilot is free to use, locally installed, and does not require a mandatory cloud account or subscription. Do not imply that VPS hosting itself is free.

2. Website information architecture

Page	Purpose	MVP content
Home	Main product landing page	Hero, product preview, key features, local-first message, platform support, download CTA.
Features	Explain product capabilities	Feature groups, screenshots, availability labels where needed.
Download	Help visitors install the app	OS selector, release version, installer links, checksums, install notes.
Documentation	Help users get started	Installation, first connection, SSH keys, server management, troubleshooting.
Changelog	Show product progress	Version, release date, added features, fixes, known issues.
About	Explain the project	Product purpose, GitHub, contact, license and privacy links.

3. Homepage layout and UI

Section 01 — Navigation

- Left: ServerPilot wordmark and logo.

- Links: Features, Download, Documentation, GitHub.
- Right: primary Download button.
- Sticky navigation with a subtle border after scrolling.
- Mobile menu with a simple open/close transition.

Section 02 — Hero

Headline: Your servers. One desktop. Full control.

Description: Manage your VPS servers from one powerful desktop application. Connect through SSH, monitor resources, manage services, browse files, and work with your servers from one place.

- Primary CTA: Download ServerPilot.
- Secondary CTA: Explore Features.
- Supporting note: Free to use · Windows · macOS · Linux · No cloud account required.
- Visual: a large, real screenshot of the desktop application. Optional small terminal or monitoring detail can sit around it.

Section 03 — Product preview

- Place a large application screenshot near the top of the page.
- Use tabs or a small gallery for Overview, Servers, Terminal, Services, and File Manager.
- Use screenshots from the actual released application, not fabricated UI.
- Allow visitors to view larger screenshots in a lightbox.

Section 04 — Core features

Feature	Description
Server management	Add, organize, connect to, and manage multiple VPS servers.
SSH connections	Connect using SSH credentials or keys, with host fingerprint verification.
Server monitoring	View CPU, memory, disk, network, and uptime when supported.
Interactive terminal	Run commands in an integrated terminal.
Service management	Inspect and control supported services.
Laravel tools	Discover Laravel projects and run supported Artisan operations.
File manager	Browse, upload, and download remote files over SFTP.
Database access	Connect to supported databases through secure connections, where implemented.
Docker management	Inspect and manage containers where implemented.
Logs and tasks	View supported logs, cron tasks, and operation history.

Accuracy rule: Only describe features that are available in the current build as released features. Mark incomplete capabilities as “Coming soon” or omit them. Do not imply universal compatibility with every Linux distribution or service.

Section 05 — How it works

Step	Title	Description
01	Install ServerPilot	Download the installer for your operating system.
02	Connect your VPS	Add the server address, SSH port, username, and authentication method.
03	Manage your server	Monitor, configure, and control supported server features from the desktop app.

Section 06 — Local-first and privacy

Headline: Your infrastructure stays yours.

- The desktop application runs locally on the user's computer.
- It connects directly to VPS servers using SSH and related protocols.
- No mandatory ServerPilot cloud account or hosted backend.
- No required ServerPilot agent installed on the VPS.
- Credentials should be stored using the operating system's secure credential storage.
- Be precise about data handling. SSH connections exchange data with the remote server, so avoid claiming that no data ever leaves the computer.

Section 07 — Platform support

Platform	Package formats to show when published
macOS	DMG / app bundle
Windows	MSI / EXE
Linux	DEB / RPM / AppImage

Display only installers that exist for the current release. Include version number, release date, file size, CPU architecture, and checksum when available.

Section 08 — Final download CTA

Headline: Take control of your servers.

One desktop application. All your servers. No cloud account required.

CTA: Download ServerPilot. Supporting note: Free to use · Cross-platform.

Section 09 — Footer

- Product links and platform downloads.
- Documentation and changelog.
- GitHub repository and contact.
- Privacy policy and license information.
- Copyright notice.

4. Visual design system

The first release uses a strict monochrome palette. Keep the visual language consistent across all pages.

Token	Value	Usage
White	#FFFFFF	Main page background and light surfaces.
Near white	#F5F5F5	Subtle section backgrounds and preview panels.
Gray	#737373	Secondary text and muted labels.
Border gray	#E5E5E5	Dividers, card borders, and input borders.
Black	#111111	Primary text, dark sections, buttons, and strong contrast.

Typography

- Use Inter or Geist Sans for headings and body text.
- Use Geist Mono or JetBrains Mono for technical labels and code examples.
- Headlines should be bold and concise.
- Body text should be 16–18px on desktop with comfortable line height.

Layout and components

Element	Guideline
Content width	About 1,200px maximum, centered.
Hero headline	64–80px desktop; scale down responsively.
Section headline	40–52px desktop.
Body text	16–18px.
Card padding	24–32px.
Section spacing	100–140px desktop; less on mobile.
Mobile side padding	About 20px.
Corners	10–16px radius; use consistently.
Shadows	Avoid heavy shadows. Prefer whitespace and thin borders.

5. Motion and interaction

Animation should make the site feel responsive, not distract visitors. Prefer short transitions and respect the reduced-motion setting.

Interaction	Suggested behavior	Duration
Button hover	Subtle color or opacity change; tiny movement if useful.	150ms
Card hover	Small lift or border change.	200ms
Screenshot gallery	Crossfade between images.	350ms

Interaction	Suggested behavior	Duration
Section reveal	Fade in with slight upward movement.	500ms
Page transition	Short fade where supported.	200ms

- Use CSS transitions and keyframes for simple effects.
- Use IntersectionObserver for scroll-triggered reveals.
- Astro View Transitions can provide page navigation transitions where appropriate.
- Avoid parallax-heavy effects, constant motion, and long intro animations.
- Support prefers-reduced-motion and disable nonessential movement when requested.

6. Astro technology stack

Area	Recommendation
Framework	Astro
Language	TypeScript
Styling	Tailwind CSS
UI components	Astro components by default.
Interactive UI	React components only where interaction needs them.
Icons	Lucide.
Animation	CSS transitions/keyframes, IntersectionObserver, Astro View Transitions.
Content	Astro Content Collections for documentation and changelog.
Deployment	Cloudflare Pages or Vercel.
Release downloads	GitHub Releases or another stable release host.

Do not build the entire marketing site in React. Astro should render the mostly static pages. Use React islands for features such as an operating-system selector, screenshot gallery, or interactive product demo only when needed.

7. Suggested project structure

```
serverpilot-website/
├── public/
│ ├── favicon.svg
│ ├── logo.svg
│ ├── og-image.png
│ └── screenshots/
│ ├── dashboard.png
│ ├── servers.png
│ ├── terminal.png
│ ├── services.png
│ └── file-manager.png
├── src/
│ ├── components/
│ │ ├── layout/
│ │ │ ├── Navbar.astro
```

```
│ │ │ ├── Footer.astro
│ │ │ └── Container.astro
│ │ ├── home/
│ │ │ ├── Hero.astro
│ │ │ ├── ProductPreview.astro
│ │ │ ├── Features.astro
│ │ │ ├── HowItWorks.astro
│ │ │ ├── Privacy.astro
│ │ │ └── DownloadCTA.astro
│ │ └── ui/
│ ├── content/
│ │ ├── docs/
│ │ └── changelog/
│ ├── layouts/
│ │ └── BaseLayout.astro
│ ├── pages/
│ │ ├── index.astro
│ │ ├── features.astro
│ │ ├── download.astro
│ │ ├── docs/
│ │ ├── changelog.astro
│ │ └── about.astro
│ ├── styles/
│ │ └── global.css
│ └── data/
│ ├── features.ts
│ └── releases.ts
├── astro.config.mjs
├── package.json
└── tsconfig.json
```

8. Responsive design

Breakpoint	Behavior
Mobile	Single-column sections, compact navigation, stacked CTAs, swipeable or scrollable screenshot gallery.
Tablet	Two-column feature layouts where space allows; medium hero typography.
Desktop	Wide hero, multi-column feature grid, large product screenshots, generous whitespace.

The website must remain readable and usable at narrow widths. Avoid fixed-width screenshot containers that cause horizontal overflow.

9. Content, SEO, and sharing

- Give every page a unique title and meta description.
- Add canonical URLs, sitemap.xml, and robots.txt.
- Use Open Graph and social preview images for sharing.
- Use descriptive alt text for application screenshots.
- Add structured data for SoftwareApplication only when product facts such as operating systems, license, and download details are accurate.
- Use optimized WebP or AVIF screenshots where supported, with sensible image dimensions.
- Keep the main content server-rendered and accessible without client-side JavaScript.

10. Download and release experience

- Detect the visitor's operating system only as a convenience, not as the only way to choose a download.
- Always show explicit Windows, macOS, and Linux choices.
- Link directly to published release assets.
- Show the current version and release date.
- Include architecture details such as x64 or ARM64 when relevant.
- Provide checksums and signing information when available.
- Link to installation instructions and troubleshooting.
- Do not show fake download counts, ratings, or unsupported platform badges.

11. Accessibility and performance

- Use semantic HTML and a logical heading hierarchy.
- Ensure keyboard navigation and visible focus states.
- Maintain strong text contrast in both white and black sections.
- Provide accessible labels for interactive controls.
- Use reduced-motion preferences.
- Lazy-load below-the-fold screenshots and avoid loading large images in the hero unnecessarily.
- Keep JavaScript limited to genuinely interactive components.
- Test page speed, mobile layout, and keyboard access before release.

12. MVP implementation phases

Phase	Work	Deliverable
1. Foundation	Create Astro + TypeScript project, Tailwind, global tokens, base layout, navbar, footer.	Responsive site foundation.
2. Homepage	Build hero, product preview, feature grid, how-it-works, privacy, platform support, CTA.	Complete landing page.
3. Product pages	Build Features, Download, About, and Changelog pages.	Main public website.
4. Documentation	Add getting-started and common usage guides.	Useful user documentation.
5. Motion and polish	Add restrained transitions, responsive refinements, accessibility checks.	Polished user experience.
6. Launch	SEO, social metadata, analytics if desired, deployment, broken-link checks.	Production website.

13. MVP acceptance checklist

- The website clearly identifies ServerPilot as a desktop VPS management application.
- The local-first and direct SSH model is explained accurately.
- The homepage includes a clear hero and download action.
- Real screenshots show the current desktop application.
- Only implemented features are described as available.
- Download links point to real published installers.
- Windows, macOS, and Linux are represented accurately.
- All pages work on mobile, tablet, and desktop.
- The monochrome design is consistent across the site.
- Animations are subtle and respect reduced-motion preferences.
- Navigation, buttons, screenshots, and links work.
- SEO metadata, sitemap, and social preview are configured.
- The site remains useful when client-side JavaScript is unavailable.

14. Explicitly out of scope for the first release

- User accounts or a cloud dashboard for managing servers.
- A web-based replacement for the desktop application.
- A hosted server monitoring backend.
- A public community forum or complex support portal.
- A CMS unless the project later needs non-developer content editing.
- Heavy 3D animation or complex WebGL scenes.
- Unverified testimonials, customer logos, download statistics, or compatibility claims.

15. Final design direction

Build a quiet, confident product website. Let the desktop application screenshots do most of the selling. Use large typography, strong contrast, precise spacing, thin borders, and restrained motion. The website should feel like a polished developer tool, not a generic SaaS template.

ServerPilot
Your servers. One desktop. Full control.